LENA VARGA-HOLM

Senior Data Engineer

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PROFILE

Data engineer with 9 years of experience building batch and streaming data platforms for e-commerce and payments. Build and operate reusable, well-tested data platforms with clear data contracts and trusted analytical warehouses.

SKILLS

Programming & query languages: Python, SQL, Bash

Data platform & quality: Airflow, dbt, Kafka, Kafka Connect, Debezium, Great Expectations, JSON Schema, data contracts

Data processing & warehouses: Spark (PySpark), Snowflake, Redshift, PostgreSQL

Cloud, infrastructure & CI/CD: AWS (S3, EMR, Glue, Lambda, IAM), Docker, Terraform (basic), GitHub Actions

BI: Power BI, Looker (basic)

EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Engineer - Lukovac Freight Hub d.o.o. (logistics marketplace), Rijeka *03/2022 - present*

- Own the ingestion layer of the company data platform: ~140 Airflow DAGs loading from Postgres, MySQL, Salesforce and 3rd-party APIs into Snowflake.
- Migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into 420+ dbt models with tests, documentation, incremental models, and slim CI in GitHub Actions; reduced the nightly warehouse build from 5h10 to 1h35.
- Introduced data contracts between product teams and the data team (JSON Schema + CI checks), cutting broken-pipeline incidents from ~9/month to ~2/month.
- Built a Kafka-based event pipeline (Kafka Connect + Snowpipe Streaming) for shipment tracking events, ~30M events/day.
- Replaced hourly full-table extracts from PostgreSQL with Debezium CDC into Kafka and Snowflake, reducing replica CPU during loads from approximately 70% to 25%.
- Reduced the Snowflake bill from about $38K/month to $24K/month through warehouse sizing and auto-suspend.
- Participate in the data-platform on-call rotation (one week in six).
- Mentor two mid-level data engineers; run the weekly data platform office hours.

Data Engineer - Kovalent Pay (payments startup), Zagreb *09/2019 - 02/2022*

- Built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR for transaction reconciliation (daily ~1.2 TB of raw files from S3).
- Designed the Redshift warehouse schema (star schema, 30+ fact/dimension tables) used by finance and risk.
- Set up data quality checks with Great Expectations on critical finance tables.
- Wrote internal Python library for S3/Glue catalog access used by 4 teams.

Junior Data Engineer / BI Developer - Adria Retail Group, Split *06/2017 - 08/2019*

- Maintained SSIS packages and T-SQL ETL into an on-prem SQL Server warehouse.

- Built Power BI reports for store operations (40+ stores).
- Migrated 60 nightly SSIS jobs to Python scripts scheduled with cron.

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

Airflow provider contribution (2023) - Fixed a pagination bug and added tests in a community Airflow provider for a SaaS CRM API; 2 merged pull requests. Technologies: Python, Airflow, pytest.

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science (Data Science track) - Northgate Technical University, 2017

Thesis: Incremental materialized views for analytical queries

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Data Engineer – Associate (May 2024)

LANGUAGES

Croatian (native), English (C1), German (B1)